Margaret Osei

Programme Director | Global Health

Contact

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Profile

Programme director with sixteen years in public health and humanitarian work. I turn complex funding and field realities into programmes that run on time, stay on budget and reach the people they are meant for.

Key Achievements

- Directed programmes reaching 2.1 million people across six countries.
- Raised 6.5 million pounds in multi-year grants from institutional donors.
- Built and led teams of up to 40 people across four time zones.
- Introduced a monitoring framework now used by all eleven programmes at Helix.

Professional Experience

Programme Director

Helix Health Foundation · Manchester, United Kingdom
Feb 2020 – Present

Direct a portfolio of eleven health programmes across six countries with a combined budget of 18 million pounds.

- Brought three programmes back on budget within nine months after a funding review.
- Built a monitoring framework adopted by all eleven programme teams.
- Negotiated two multi-year grants worth 6.5 million pounds in total.
- Lead a leadership team of seven programme managers and two finance partners.
- Present quarterly results to the board and to the three largest donors.

Senior Programme Manager

Helix Health Foundation · Manchester, United Kingdom
Sep 2016 – Jan 2020

Managed the maternal health programme in West Africa.

- Trained 1,200 community health workers in four regions.
- Cut the reporting cycle from 90 to 45 days with a mobile data tool.
- Opened a second field office and hired a team of 14.
- Worked with ministries of health on national guidelines.

Programme Manager
Northern Relief Alliance · Leeds, United Kingdom
Jan 2013 – Aug 2016

Ran emergency response and recovery programmes after floods and storms.

- Coordinated aid for 25,000 people after the 2015 winter floods.
- Set up a volunteer network of 300 people ready to deploy within 48 hours.
- Wrote the alliance's first safeguarding policy.
- Reduced the cost per household supported by 20%.

Project Officer
Northern Relief Alliance · Leeds, United Kingdom
Jun 2010 – Dec 2012

Supported project teams with planning, budgets and reports.

- Prepared monthly budget reports for eight projects.
- Organised training days for 150 volunteers.
- Wrote donor reports that secured two renewals.

Policy Assistant
City of Leeds Council · Leeds, United Kingdom
Sep 2008 – May 2010

Worked in the public health policy team.

- Researched and summarised evidence for three local health strategies.
- Drafted answers to public enquiries and councillor questions.
- Helped organise a city-wide wellbeing survey with 4,000 responses.

Research Intern
Harlow Community Trust · Leeds, United Kingdom
Jan 2008 – Aug 2008

Short placement during the final year of studies.

- Interviewed 40 residents for a study on access to local services.
- Prepared tables and charts for the trust's annual report.

Skills

DHIS2
Programme management
Advanced skills
Power BI
Donor relations
Microsoft Project
Budget management
KoBoToolbox
Monitoring and evaluation
Team leadership

Stakeholder engagement

Safeguarding

Education

Master of Public Health, Global Health Policy

University of Manchester · 2011 – 2012

Graduated with distinction. Dissertation on community health workers in rural Ghana.

Bachelor's degree, Sociology

University of Leeds · 2005 – 2008

First class honours.

Certifications

PMP – Project Management Professional

Project Management Institute · Jun 2017

PRINCE2 Practitioner

AXELOS · Mar 2014

Certified Humanitarian Professional

CHS Alliance · Oct 2019

Projects

Mobile Data Collection Rollout

Introduced tablets and an offline reporting app to 160 clinics, replacing paper registers.

Community Health Worker Handbook

helixhealth.example.com/handbook

Wrote and field-tested a plain-language handbook now used in three countries.

Volunteering

Trustee

Leeds Food Bank · Leeds, United Kingdom

Jan 2014 – Dec 2019

Served on the board of a food bank supporting 1,500 households a year.

- Chaired the finance committee for three years.
- Led a fundraising drive that raised 85,000 pounds.

Mentor

Girls Who Code Manchester · Manchester, United Kingdom

Mar 2021 – Present

Mentor teenage girls in a weekly after-school coding club.

- Run monthly sessions on careers in technology and health.

Awards

Public Health Leader of the Year

UK Global Health Network · Nov 2022

Awarded for leadership of the maternal health programme in West Africa.

Chair's Award

Northern Relief Alliance · Jul 2016

Awarded for the response to the 2015 winter floods.

Training Courses

Leading Complex Programmes

London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine · May 2018

Donor Relations and Grant Writing

Bond · Feb 2015

Safeguarding for Managers

Humentum · Nov 2016

Publications

Community health workers and maternal outcomes in rural West Africa

Journal of Global Health Practice · Aug 2019

Counting what counts: monitoring frameworks for small programmes

Development in Practice · Apr 2021

Languages

English – Native

Twi – Fluent

French – Professional working proficiency

Interests

long-distance running, community gardening, choir singing

References

Available on request.